STHIROS
Strategy. Risk. Cyber. AI.



Finding anti-forensic tools and unauthorised access behind a suspected data theft

A software company suspected intellectual property theft and unauthorised system access, and engaged Sthiros for a digital forensic investigation to find out.

Client	Service	Sector	Geography
A Software Company	**Digital Forensic Investigation**	**Software Development & IT Services**	**Global**

The Challenge:

When suspicion exists but no evidence does yet

This software company suspected data theft and unauthorised access to its systems, but had no forensically sound evidence to confirm it, act on it, or use it in any legal proceeding.

Suspected IP Theft

Intellectual property was suspected of being taken via removable media, network copy, printing, or deliberate deletion.

Suspected Unauthorised Remote Access

Unauthorised users were suspected of accessing the company's systems remotely, outside any approved channel.

No Documented Evidence to Prove Data Theft

Suspicion existed, but no forensically sound evidence had yet been collected to confirm or act on it.

The Solution:

A forensically sound investigation, built for legal admissibility

Sthiros ran a digital forensic investigation of the company-issued desktop, acquiring and analysing a forensically sound disk image while preserving chain-of-custody throughout.

Every artifact recovered, from deleted files to remote access logs, was documented in a way that could stand up in court, not just internally.

The Methodology

1 Hard Disk Image Acquisition

A forensically sound image of the company-issued desktop acquired, preserving the original evidence intact.

2 Hard Disk Image Analysis

The acquired image analysed with forensic tools to recover deleted files, artifacts, and system activity.

3 Chain-of-Custody Preservation

Every step of evidence handling documented to preserve legal admissibility from acquisition through to reporting.

4 Timeline Analysis & Artifact Recovery

File access timestamps and metadata reconstructed into a timeline, recovering artifacts of deletion, access, and tool usage.

What This Means

Deleted isn't gone.

Build evidence that holds in court.

Reconstruct the timeline, not the story.

Outcomes

Data Deletion

Traces identified

File system analysis recovered evidence of deliberate deletion.

Unauthorised Access

Detected

Remote access to company systems by unauthorised users confirmed.

Court-Admissible

Evidence collected

Chain-of-custody preserved throughout for legal admissibility.

Anti-Forensic Tools

Usage discovered

Deliberate attempts to obstruct investigation identified and documented.

Get in touch

Is your suspicion evidence-backed, or just a hunch?

Speak to Sthiros about what a structured digital forensic investigation can unlock for your.

Connect with us:
sthiros.com

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